After the coffee came, Rose leaned forward and asked about Josef. “Could you ever love him?”

“What?” She laughed. “There’s nothing between us. Why would you think that?”

Rose shrugged. “Just curious. You spend a lot of time together.”

“We’re working together.”

“Right.” Rose sipped her coffee. “Has he ever tried to kiss you?”

“I said there’s nothing between us.”

“I still dream about the night I kissed André in the cinema.”

It seemed somehow wrong to think about love surrounded by the haunting images on Berlin’s streets—black crepe bands, camouflage nets, bomb shelter signs—all pointing to the violent end awaiting them. “Have you ever wondered how we will get back home?” She asked.

“The French army will come and get us.” Rose sipped her coffee.

“Most of that army is over here in prison camps.”

“You mean we will have to find our way home?”

“Maybe.” Léa sighed. “I don’t know.”

“What about all the POWs? They won’t just leave them here.”

“Remember how the French POWs at Glashütte dismissed us. One of them spat at you, as if we didn’t deserve to be French. Do you think they will change their opinion after the war? Will anyone care what happens to us or welcome our return?” She breathed in deeply. So much hatred had been ginned up in people, turning them against one another, that she suspected not even the war ending would stop it.